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The paper is attempting to trace back the etymologies of some of the phrases and common expressions, highlighting a definite, probable and possible influence of Latin on Hebrew and Arabic.

John Charles SMITH: **The refunctionalization of number in Late Latin neuter nouns**

It is well known that Latin, even during the Classical Period, had neuter / feminine doublets which resulted from the reinterpretation of the neuter plural -A inflection as a feminine singular (see, for instance, Väänänen 1981: 102). The number of such doublets increased dramatically in Late Latin. Following the absorption of neuter singulars by the masculine gender, some of these oppositions survived in one or more Romance languages as distinct lexical items distinguished by masculine vs. feminine gender (compare Latin FOLIVM vs. FOLIA, yielding Italian *foglio* vs. *foglia*, Old French *fueil* vs. *fueille*). In other words, in Late Latin and Romance, a morphological distinction of number was refunctionalized first of all as a morphological distinction of gender and then as a distinction between two separate lexical items.

It has been claimed (Donohue and Smith 1998; Smith 1999, 2005) that refunctionalization is not random, but conforms to a principle of "core-to-core mapping", whereby the new opposition retains, however abstractly, some element or feature which is present in the original opposition. A central tenet of this claim is that markedness relationships remain constant. In this paper, I shall examine the process outlined above in the light of this hypothesis and show, in particular, that there is some correlation between the plural > feminine forms and literal meaning, on the one hand, and the singular > neuter > masculine forms and figurative meaning, on the other. A priori, this development is the opposite of what might be expected under the "core-to-core" hypothesis, as singular number, masculine gender, and literal meaning are all, in an obvious sense, unmarked. I shall discuss whether and how the "core-to-core" hypothesis needs to be refined in the light of these phenomena.

Brent VINE: **Notes on the language and text of some Late Republican *defixiones***

The popular Latin of Late Republican *defixiones* provides some of the earliest and most important documentation for Vulgar Latin. These notes take as their starting point certain features in the *defixio* from Carmona (J. Corell, *ZPE* 95 [1993], 261-68; cf. also F. Maltomini, *ZPE* 107 [1995], 297-98, and L. Agostiniani, in *Italica Matritensia* [*Atti del IV Convegno SILFI*, ed. M. T. N. Salazar, 1998], pp.25-35).

1. COTIDEA (line 3, ACCEDAT.MORBO.COTIDEA) poses severe difficulties. Corell (266) understood the form as standing for "cot(t)idie", with E for I as an "umgekehrte Schreibweise", and A as an error. But the text is carefully engraved, and Corell admits that, while IA > IE is documented, the reverse is unknown. I suggest that COTIDEA - almost at line-end, with a densely-packed text to follow in the fourth (and final) line - is an abbreviation, e.g. COTIDEA(NVS) or COTIDEA(NOM), depending on how one interprets the case of MORBO. (Given other archaisms in this text, prevocalic E for I is perhaps best understood as a non-urban archaic feature: cf. the type FILEA, e.g. *CIL* I(2) 60, Praeneste [3rd/2nd c. BC].) Less likely, but possible, would be an abbreviation of the adverb COTIDEA(NO) "cotidie" (Plautus, Afranius, etc.).

2. The sequences following the name of the accursed both alliterate: CAPVT.COR. CO(n)SILIO(m), and VALETVDINE(m).VITA(m). Corell merely remarks (265) that the alliteration in the first is certainly intentional, while in the second it "seems intentional". But there is a great deal more to say about such alliterative patterns in late Republican *defixiones*, including correspondences with Oscan / Campanian practice. First, note a remarkable parallel near the beginning of the "Fox" Johns Hopkins *defixiones* (*CIL* I(2) 2520): **CORP**[US].COLOREM. **VIRES.VIRTUTES**. Note further VITA(m).VALETVDIN(em) in a Campanian *defixio* (*DT* 195.3), both to be compared with the heavily alliterating Oscan *defixio* from Cumae (Rix *ST* Cm.13; late 2nd/early 1st cent. BC), with a sequence **biass.biitam**, paralleled in Ennius' "vires vitaque" (37 Sk), as often discussed. These facts, and similar ones from other Campanian *defixiones*, suggest that the marked dialectal features of the "Fox" *defixiones* should be taken more seriously, and with them the Campanian contribution to Vulgar Latin. A new "Campanian Latin" feature, well-attested in late-Republican *defixiones*, will also be tentatively suggested.